

Absolutely — **encourage** is a very useful polysemy/family target because your passage uses the adjective here:

> “However, not all comments were **encouraging**.”

Here **encouraging** means **giving hope, confidence, reassurance, or a positive feeling that things are going well**. But the family also extends into **urging someone to act, promoting behaviour, making something more likely, supporting development, positive signs/results, and institutional/business uses**.

Word family: **encourage / encouragement / encouraging / encouraged / encouragingly**

Base verb: encourage

Noun: encouragement

Adjective: encouraging

Adjective/participle: encouraged

Adverb: encouragingly

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞) / adjective (形容詞)

Major domains:

- * emotional support
- * motivation
- * urging action
- * promoting behaviour
- * education/workplace
- * policy/economics
- * development/growth
- * positive evidence/signs
- * interpersonal reassurance

Meaning in your passage: **encouraging = giving confidence, hope, or positive reassurance — 鼓舞人心的；令人受到鼓勵的；令人感到正面的**

Your sentence:

> “However, not all comments were **encouraging**.”

Here **encouraging** means:

> **positive and supportive enough to make the writer feel reassured, appreciated, or more confident.**

繁體中文：

****能給人信心、希望、支持或正面感受的；令人受到鼓勵的****

Natural translation:

> “However, not all comments were encouraging.”

「不過，並不是所有留言都****令人感到鼓舞 / 都是支持性的****。」

So here:

> ****encouraging = 內容帶有支持、肯定、正面回應，能令人更有信心或感到被支持****

A. GIVE SOMEONE CONFIDENCE / HOPE

1. ****encourage someone = give someone confidence or hope — 鼓勵某人；給某人信心****

The core interpersonal meaning.

Practice 1

> “Her teacher ****encouraged**** her before the exam.”

「老師在考試前****鼓勵她****。」

Practice 2

> “His friends encouraged him when he felt nervous.”

「他感到緊張時，朋友們****給了他鼓勵****。」

****encourage someone = 透過支持、安慰或正面說話令某人更有信心、希望或勇氣****

2. ****encourage someone to do something = 鼓勵某人做某事****

A major construction.

Practice 3

> “The teacher ****encouraged students to ask questions****.”

「老師****鼓勵學生提問****。」

Practice 4

> “Her friends encouraged her to keep creating videos.”

「她的朋友**鼓勵她繼續創作影片**。」

encourage someone to do X = 給予支持、建議或推動，使某人更願意去做 X

B. ENCOURAGEMENT

3. **encouragement = support that gives confidence — 鼓勵；支持；勉勵**

Practice 5

> “She needed some **encouragement**.”

「她需要一些**鼓勵**。」

Practice 6

> “His words of encouragement helped me continue.”

「他的**鼓勵說話**幫助我堅持下去。」

encouragement = 能提升信心、希望或行動意欲的支持 / 說話

4. **words of encouragement = 鼓勵的說話；勉勵**

Practice 7

> “The coach offered a few **words of encouragement**.”

「教練說了幾句**鼓勵的話**。」

Practice 8

> “A few words of encouragement can make a big difference.”

「幾句**鼓勵說話**也可以帶來很大影響。」

C. ENCOURAGING — SUPPORTIVE

5. **encouraging = supportive / confidence-giving — 鼓舞人心的；支持性的**

This is your exact passage branch.

Practice 9 — Original

> “Not all comments were **encouraging**.”

「並不是所有留言都**令人受到鼓勵 / 都是支持性的**。」

Practice 10

> “She received several encouraging messages.”

「她收到幾則**令人鼓舞的訊息**。」

encouraging = 能令人更有信心、希望或勇氣的

D. ENCOURAGED — FEELING MORE CONFIDENT / HOPEFUL

6. **encouraged = feeling more hopeful/confident — 受到鼓舞的；感到有信心的**

Practice 11

> “I felt **encouraged** by the positive feedback.”

「正面的回饋令我**受到鼓舞**。」

Practice 12

> “She was encouraged by her progress.”

「自己的進步令她**更有信心**。」

encouraged = 因支持、進展或好跡象而感到更有希望 / 信心

7. **be encouraged by + thing = 因……而受到鼓舞**

Practice 13

> “We were **encouraged by** the results.”

「結果令我們**感到鼓舞**。」

Practice 14

> “He was encouraged by the number of supportive comments.”

「支持性的留言數量令他**受到鼓舞**。」

8. **feel encouraged to do something = 因受支持而更願意做某事**

Practice 15

> “She felt **encouraged to continue**.”

「她受到鼓勵，因此更願意**繼續下去**。」

Practice 16

> “Students should feel encouraged to speak openly.”

「學生應該感到有人支持他們，因此敢於**坦誠發言**。」

E. ENCOURAGE ACTION / BEHAVIOUR

9. **encourage something = promote / make behaviour more likely — 鼓勵；促進；助長**

A major distinct sense.

Practice 17

> “The policy **encourages recycling**.”

「這項政策**鼓勵回收**。」

Practice 18

> “Low prices may encourage higher consumption.”

「低價格可能會**促使 / 鼓勵更多消費**。」

****encourage X = 令某種行為、活動或結果更容易發生 / 更普遍****

Here no specific person needs to be emotionally encouraged.

F. ENCOURAGE PARTICIPATION

10. **encourage participation = 鼓勵參與；促進參與**

Practice 19

> “The programme is designed to ****encourage participation****.”

「這個計劃旨在****鼓勵參與****。」

Practice 20

> “Open discussion can encourage wider participation.”

「開放討論可以****促進更多人參與****。」

11. **encourage engagement = 鼓勵互動；提高參與度**

Practice 21

> “The platform uses notifications to ****encourage engagement****.”

「平台利用通知來****鼓勵互動 / 提高參與度****。」

Practice 22

> “Questions can encourage audience engagement.”

「提問可以****促進觀眾參與****。」

Very relevant to social media.

G. ENCOURAGE USE / ADOPTION

12. **encourage the use of + thing = 鼓勵使用.....**

Practice 23

> “The school **encourages** the use of digital tools.”

「學校**鼓勵使用**數碼工具。」

Practice 24

> “The scheme encourages the use of public transport.”

「這項計劃**鼓勵使用**公共交通。」

13. **encourage adoption** = 推動採用；鼓勵採納

Practice 25

> “Lower costs may **encourage adoption** of the technology.”

「較低成本可能會**推動這項技術的採用**。」

Practice 26

> “Training can encourage faster adoption of the new system.”

「培訓可以**促進新系統更快被採用**。」

H. ENCOURAGE DEVELOPMENT / GROWTH

14. **encourage growth** = 促進增長；促進生長

A very common cross-domain use.

Practice 27

> “The policy aims to **encourage economic growth**.”

「這項政策旨在**促進經濟增長**。」

Practice 28

> “Warm conditions encourage plant growth.”

「溫暖的環境會**促進植物生長**。」

encourage growth = 創造有利條件，使某種增長 / 生長更容易發生

15. **encourage development = 促進發展**

Practice 29

> “Reading can encourage language development.”

「閱讀可以**促進語言發展**。」

Practice 30

> “The programme encourages professional development.”

「這個計劃**促進專業發展**。」

I. ECONOMIC / BUSINESS INCENTIVES

16. **encourage investment = 鼓勵投資；促進投資**

Practice 31

> “Tax incentives may **encourage investment**.”

「稅務優惠可能會**鼓勵投資**。」

Practice 32

> “The reform was intended to encourage foreign investment.”

「改革旨在**吸引 / 鼓勵外來投資**。」

17. **encourage innovation = 鼓勵創新；促進創新**

Practice 33

> “Competition can **encourage innovation**.”

「競爭可以**促進創新**。」

Practice 34

> “The company created a fund to encourage innovation.”

「公司設立基金來**鼓勵創新**。」

18. **encourage competition = 鼓勵 / 促進競爭**

Practice 35

> “The changes were designed to **encourage competition**.”

「這些改動旨在**促進競爭**。」

Practice 36

> “Greater transparency can encourage healthy competition.”

「提高透明度可以**促進良性競爭**。」

J. EDUCATION / LEARNING

19. **encourage learning = 鼓勵 / 促進學習**

Practice 37

> “Good feedback should **encourage learning**.”

「好的回饋應該**促進學習**。」

Practice 38

> “Games can encourage active learning.”

「遊戲可以**促進主動學習**。」

20. **encourage curiosity = 鼓勵好奇心**

Practice 39

> “Teachers should **encourage curiosity**.”

「教師應該**鼓勵學生保持好奇心**。」

Practice 40

> “Open questions encourage curiosity and discussion.”

「開放式問題可以**激發好奇心和討論**。」

21. **encourage independence = 鼓勵自主；培養獨立性**

Practice 41

> “Parents can **encourage independence** by giving children small responsibilities.”

「家長可以透過給予孩子一些小責任來**培養獨立性**。」

Practice 42

> “The course encourages independent learning.”

「這門課**鼓勵自主學習**。」

K. WORKPLACE / LEADERSHIP

22. **encourage staff = 鼓勵員工**

Practice 43

> “Managers should **encourage staff** to share ideas.”

「經理應該**鼓勵員工**分享想法。」

Practice 44

> “She encouraged the team during a difficult project.”

「在艱難的項目期間，她一直**鼓勵團隊**。」

23. **encourage collaboration = 鼓勵協作；促進合作**

Practice 45

> “The new office layout **encourages collaboration**.”

「新的辦公室設計**促進合作**。」

Practice 46

> “Shared goals can encourage collaboration across departments.”

「共同目標可以**促進跨部門協作**。」

24. **encourage communication = 促進溝通**

Practice 47

> “Regular meetings encourage better communication.”

「定期會議可以**促進更好的溝通**。」

Practice 48

> “Managers should encourage open communication.”

「管理人員應該**鼓勵開放溝通**。」

L. POLICY / SOCIAL BEHAVIOUR

25. **encourage people to + behaviour = 鼓勵人們.....**

Practice 49

> “The campaign encourages people to exercise more.”

「這項宣傳活動**鼓勵人們多做運動**。」

Practice 50

> “The law is designed to encourage safer driving.”

「這項法律旨在**鼓勵更安全的駕駛行為**。」

M. NEGATIVE OR UNDESIRABLE BEHAVIOUR

26. **encourage bad behaviour = 助長不良行為**

Important: **encourage** is not always positive.

Practice 51

> “Ignoring the behaviour may **encourage it**.”

「不理會這種行為可能會**助長它**。」

Practice 52

> “Easy access can encourage misuse.”

「太容易取得可能會**助長濫用**。」

encourage = 使某種行為更可能發生，即使該行為本身是負面的

27. **encourage violence/crime = 助長暴力 / 犯罪**

Practice 53

> “Officials argued that the message could **encourage violence**.”

「有關人士認為該訊息可能會**助長暴力**。」

Practice 54

> “Poor enforcement can encourage illegal activity.”

「執法不力可能會**助長非法活動**。」

So Chinese often changes from:

> 鼓勵

> to:

> 助長

depending on whether the outcome is undesirable.

N. ENCOURAGE DEPENDENCE

28. **encourage dependence = 助長依賴**

Very relevant to your previous word.

Practice 55

> “Constant reassurance can **encourage dependence**.”

「不斷給予安撫可能會**助長依賴**。」

Practice 56

> “Some design features may encourage dependence on the platform.”

「某些設計功能可能會**增加 / 助長對平台的依賴**。」

O. ENCOURAGE SPENDING / CONSUMPTION

29. **encourage spending = 刺激 / 鼓勵消費**

Practice 57

> “Discounts can **encourage spending**.”

「折扣可以**刺激消費**。」

Practice 58

> “Low interest rates may encourage borrowing and spending.”

「低利率可能會**刺激借貸和消費**。」

Business/economics:

Chinese often:

> 刺激

> rather than literal 鼓勵.

P. ENCOURAGE DEMAND

30. **encourage demand = 刺激需求**

Practice 59

> “Lower prices may **encourage demand**.”

「較低價格可能會**刺激需求**。」

Practice 60

> “Advertising can encourage demand for new products.”

「廣告可以**刺激新產品需求**。」

Q. ENCOURAGE SUPPLY / PRODUCTION

31. **encourage production = 鼓勵 / 刺激生產**

Practice 61

> “Higher prices may **encourage production**.”

「較高價格可能會**刺激生產**。」

Practice 62

> “Subsidies were introduced to encourage local production.”

「當局推出補貼以**鼓勵本地生產**。」

R. ENCOURAGE SOMEONE IN SOMETHING

32. **encourage someone in + activity/belief = 在.....方面鼓勵 / 支持某人**

A less common but valid construction.

Practice 63

> “Her parents **encouraged her in her studies**.”

「她的父母在學業方面一直**支持和鼓勵她**。」

Practice 64

> “He encouraged me in my writing.”

「他一直**鼓勵我寫作**。」

More formal/older than:

> encourage someone to do something

but still useful.

S. ENCOURAGE SOMEONE WITH SOMETHING

33. **encourage someone with + words/support = 用.....鼓勵某人**

Practice 65

> “She encouraged him **with kind words**.”

「她用親切的說話**鼓勵他**。」

Practice 66

> “The team was encouraged with regular feedback.”

「團隊透過定期回饋得到**鼓勵**。」

T. ENCOURAGING SIGN

34. **encouraging sign = 令人鼓舞的跡象；好兆頭**

A major figurative use.

Practice 67

> “The early results are an **encouraging sign**.”

「初步結果是一個**令人鼓舞的跡象 / 好兆頭**。」

Practice 68

> “More applications are an encouraging sign.”

「申請數增加是一個**正面跡象**。」

encouraging = 顯示事情可能朝好的方向發展

This does not mean someone is verbally encouraging you.

U. ENCOURAGING RESULTS

35. **encouraging results** = 令人鼓舞的結果；初步成果理想

Practice 69

> “The trial produced **encouraging results**.”

「試驗得出**令人鼓舞的結果**。」

Practice 70

> “Early test results were encouraging.”

「初步測試結果**令人樂觀**。」

encouraging results = 結果好到足以令人對未來更有信心

V. ENCOURAGING PROGRESS

36. **encouraging progress** = 令人鼓舞的進展

Practice 71

> “The patient is making **encouraging progress**.”

「病人的進展**令人鼓舞**。」

Practice 72

> “There has been encouraging progress on the project.”

「項目已有**令人樂觀的進展**。」

W. ENCOURAGING TREND

37. **encouraging trend = 令人鼓舞的趨勢；正面趨勢**

Practice 73

> “The decline in complaints is an **encouraging trend**.”

「投訴減少是一個**令人鼓舞的趨勢**。」

Practice 74

> “The figures show an encouraging trend.”

「數字顯示出一個**正面趨勢**。」

X. “THAT’S ENCOURAGING”

38. **That’s encouraging. = 這很令人鼓舞；這是好兆頭**

Practice 75

> “More students are participating.”

> “**That’s encouraging.**”

「有更多學生參與了。」

「**這是個好現象 / 很令人鼓舞。**」

Practice 76

> “The first test worked.”

> “That’s encouraging.”

「第一次測試成功了。」

「**這很令人樂觀。**」

Y. "NOT VERY ENCOURAGING"

39. **not encouraging = 不樂觀；不太令人安心**

Practice 77

> "The early figures are **not very encouraging**."

「初步數字**不太樂觀**。」

Practice 78

> "The doctor's expression was not encouraging."

「醫生的表情**不太令人安心**。」

Here:

> encouraging = giving reason for hope.

Z. ENCOURAGINGLY

40. **encouragingly = 令人鼓舞地；可喜的是**

Practice 79

> "**Encouragingly**, response rates improved."

「**令人鼓舞的是**，回覆率有所改善。」

Practice 80

> "The patient responded encouragingly to treatment."

「病人對治療的反應**頗令人樂觀**。」

encouragingly = 以令人更有希望 / 信心的方式

AA. "ENCOURAGED BY RESULTS"

41. **encouraged by evidence/results = 因跡象良好而更有信心**

Practice 81

> “Researchers were **encouraged by** the early findings.”

「初步研究結果令研究人員**感到鼓舞**。」

Practice 82

> “Investors were encouraged by stronger sales.”

「更強勁的銷售表現令投資者**信心增加**。」

AB. “BE ENCOURAGED TO...”

42. **be encouraged to do something = 被鼓勵去做.....；獲建議去做.....**

Passive construction.

Practice 83

> “Students are **encouraged to participate**.”

「學生**獲鼓勵參與**。」

Practice 84

> “Users are encouraged to change their passwords regularly.”

「使用者**獲建議 / 鼓勵定期更改密碼**。」

Important:

Depending on context, this may sound like:

- * encouragement
- * recommendation
- * soft instruction

AC. INSTITUTIONAL “ENCOURAGED TO”

43. **are encouraged to = 建議 / 宜.....**

Very common formal wording.

Practice 85

> “Visitors are **encouraged** to book in advance.”

「建議訪客**提前預約**。」

Practice 86

> “Employees are encouraged to report concerns.”

「公司**鼓勵員工**匯報疑慮。」

This can be softer than:

> must / are required to

AD. ENCOURAGE DISCUSSION / DEBATE

44. **encourage discussion** = 鼓勵 / 促進討論

Practice 87

> “The teacher asked open questions to **encourage discussion**.”

「老師提出開放式問題以**鼓勵討論**。」

Practice 88

> “The article is intended to encourage debate.”

「這篇文章旨在**引發 / 促進討論**。」

AE. ENCOURAGE EXPRESSION / CREATIVITY

45. **encourage creativity** = 鼓勵 / 激發創意

Very relevant to the passage.

Practice 89

> “Schools should **encourage creativity**.”

「學校應該**鼓勵 / 激發創意**。」

Practice 90

> “Freedom can encourage creative thinking.”

「自由可以**促進創意思考**。」

46. **encourage self-expression = 鼓勵自我表達**

Practice 91

> “Art can **encourage self-expression**.”

「藝術可以**鼓勵自我表達**。」

Practice 92

> “The platform encourages users to share personal stories.”

「平台**鼓勵使用者分享個人故事**。」

AF. ENCOURAGE CONNECTION

47. **encourage connection/interaction = 促進聯繫 / 互動**

Practice 93

> “Shared experiences can **encourage connection**.”

「共同經歷可以**促進人與人之間的聯繫**。」

Practice 94

> “The activity encourages interaction between students.”

「這項活動**促進學生之間的互動**。」

AG. ENCOURAGE RESPONSIBLE BEHAVIOUR

48. **encourage responsible behaviour = 鼓勵負責任的行為**

Practice 95

> “Clear rules can **encourage responsible behaviour** online.”

「清晰規則可以**鼓勵負責任的網上行為**。」

Practice 96

> “The policy encourages safer use of technology.”

「這項政策**鼓勵更安全地使用科技**。」

AH. “ENCOURAGE” AS CREATE CONDITIONS

49. **encourage = create favourable conditions for something — 有利於；促使**

A major semantic branch worth separating.

Practice 97

> “Warm, wet conditions **encourage mould growth**.”

「溫暖潮濕的環境**有利於霉菌生長**。」

Practice 98

> “Poor lighting can encourage eye strain.”

「照明不足可能**增加眼睛疲勞的可能性**。」

Here there is no “motivation” at all.

encourage = 環境 / 條件使某現象更容易發生

AI. BIOLOGY / AGRICULTURE

50. **encourage growth/rooting/flowering = 促進生長 / 生根 / 開花**

Practice 99

> “Regular watering **encourages root growth**.”

「定期澆水可以**促進根部生長**。」

Practice 100

> “Pruning can encourage new growth.”

「修剪可以**促進新枝生長**。」

AJ. MEDICINE / RECOVERY

51. **encourage recovery/healing = 促進康復 / 癒合**

Practice 101

> “Rest helps **encourage recovery**.”

「休息有助**促進康復**。」

Practice 102

> “Good circulation can encourage healing.”

「良好的血液循環可以**促進癒合**。」

AK. “ENCOURAGE” WITH POSITIVE VS NEGATIVE OUTCOMES

52. **encourage does not inherently mean morally good**

This is crucial.

Positive:

> “encourage exercise”

> = 鼓勵運動

Negative:

> “encourage cheating”

> = 助長作弊

Neutral/systemic:

> “warmth encourages bacterial growth”

> = 溫暖環境促進細菌生長

So the core is:

> **make something more likely / give impetus**

not:

> “do something good”.

AL. DISCOURAGE

53. **discourage someone = 令某人洩氣；打擊某人信心**

The main opposite-family verb.

Practice 103

> “Negative comments can **discourage** creators.”

「負面留言可能會令創作者**洩氣**。」

Practice 104

> “Do not let one failure discourage you.”

「不要讓一次失敗**打擊你的信心**。」

54. **discourage someone from doing something = 勸阻某人做某事**

A major separate construction.

Practice 105

> “The teacher discouraged students from copying answers.”

「老師**勸阻學生抄答案**。」

Practice 106

> “High costs may discourage people from applying.”

「高成本可能會**令一些人卻步，不去申請**。」

discourage someone from X = 令某人較不願意 / 不太可能去做 X

AM. DISCOURAGE BEHAVIOUR

55. **discourage something = 遏止；抑制；降低某行為發生**

Practice 107

> “Higher fines may **discourage illegal parking**.”

「提高罰款可能會**遏止違例泊車**。」

Practice 108

> “The design discourages unnecessary clicking.”

「這個設計會**減少不必要的點擊行為**。」

AN. DISCOURAGED

56. **discouraged = 感到洩氣的；失去信心的**

Practice 109

> “She felt **discouraged** after reading the harsh comments.”

「看完尖刻留言後，她感到很**洩氣**。」

Practice 110

> “Don’t feel discouraged by slow progress.”

「不要因進展緩慢而**灰心**。」

AO. DISCOURAGING

57. **discouraging = 令人洩氣的；令人不樂觀的**

Practice 111

> “The early results were **discouraging**.”

「初步結果**令人失望 / 不太樂觀**。」

Practice 112

> “The negative comments were discouraging.”

「那些負面留言**令人洩氣**。」

Important duality:

* emotional → 打擊信心

* evidence/results → 令人不樂觀

AP. DISCOURAGEMENT

58. **discouragement = 洩氣；挫折感；勸阻**

Practice 113

> “She continued despite moments of **discouragement**.”

「儘管有時感到**灰心**，她仍然繼續。」

Practice 114

> “Taxes may act as a discouragement to excessive consumption.”

「稅項可能對過度消費起到**抑制作用**。」

This noun can mean:

1. emotional loss of confidence
2. something that deters behaviour

AQ. ENCOURAGE VS SUPPORT

59. **encourage vs support**

encourage

= increase confidence/motivation or make action more likely.

support

= provide help, resources, agreement, or backing.

Example:

> “Her parents supported her financially and encouraged her emotionally.”

「父母在經濟上支持她，也在情緒上鼓勵她。」

Support is broader.

AR. ENCOURAGE VS MOTIVATE

60. **encourage vs motivate**

encourage

= give confidence/support or urge action.

motivate

= create the reason/desire that drives action.

> teacher encourages student

> = 老師給學生信心

> goal motivates student

> = 目標給學生行動動力

Overlap exists, but not identical.

AS. ENCOURAGE VS INSPIRE

61. **encourage vs inspire**

encourage

= support/urge someone to act.

inspire

= strongly stimulate ideas, admiration, creativity, or aspiration.

> “Her teacher encouraged her to write.”

= 老師鼓勵她寫作。

> “The novel inspired her to become a writer.”

= 小說激發她成為作家的志向。

****Inspire**** is often deeper/more transformative.

AT. ENCOURAGE VS PERSUADE

62. **encourage vs persuade**

encourage

= make someone more willing/confident.

persuade

= successfully convince someone to do/believe something.

You can encourage someone without succeeding.

> “I encouraged him to apply, but he decided not to.”

Perfectly natural.

But:

> “I persuaded him to apply”

normally implies:

> he did apply / was convinced.

AU. ENCOURAGE VS URGE

63. **encourage vs urge**

encourage

= supportive and often gentle.

urge

= strongly advise/push someone to act.

> encourage students to read

> = 鼓勵學生閱讀

> urge residents to evacuate

> = 強烈呼籲居民撤離

Urge is stronger/more urgent.

AV. ENCOURAGE VS ADVISE

64. **encourage vs advise**

advise

= recommend based on judgement/expertise.

encourage

= support and increase willingness/confidence.

> "The doctor advised her to rest."

= 醫生建議她休息。

> "Her family encouraged her to rest."

= 家人鼓勵她休息。

Different communicative function.

AW. ENCOURAGE VS REASSURE

65. **encourage vs reassure**

reassure

= reduce someone's worry/fear.

encourage

= increase confidence/hope or willingness to continue.

> reassure nervous student

> = 讓學生安心

> encourage student to continue

> = 鼓勵學生繼續

Often used together.

AX. ENCOURAGE VS COMPLIMENT

66. **encourage vs compliment**

compliment

= praise a specific quality/achievement.

encourage

= help someone feel confident or continue acting.

A compliment can function as encouragement, but not every encouragement is a compliment.

AY. ENCOURAGE VS PRAISE

67. **encourage vs praise**

praise

= express approval for what someone has done.

encourage

= help someone keep going or act.

> praise the finished essay

> = 稱讚完成的文章

> encourage the student to keep writing

> = 鼓勵學生繼續寫作

AZ. ENCOURAGE VS PROMOTE

68. **encourage vs promote**

encourage

= make activity/behaviour more likely.

promote

= actively support development, awareness, or adoption.

> encourage exercise

> = 鼓勵運動

> promote healthy lifestyles

> = 推廣健康生活方式

Promote can be more institutional/systematic.

BA. ENCOURAGE VS FOSTER

69. **encourage vs foster**

foster

= help something gradually develop over time.

encourage

= stimulate/support it more broadly.

> encourage discussion

> = 鼓勵討論

> foster trust

> = 培養信任

Foster often emphasizes gradual development.

BB. ENCOURAGE VS FACILITATE

70. **encourage vs facilitate**

encourage

= increase willingness/likelihood.

facilitate

= make something easier to do.

> incentives encourage participation

> = 誘因提高參與意願

> online forms facilitate participation

> = 網上表格令參與更容易

Not identical.

BC. ENCOURAGE VS ENABLE

71. **encourage vs enable**

encourage

= make someone more likely/willing to do something.

enable

= give actual ability/resources/opportunity to do it.

> encouragement gives confidence

> equipment enables action

Example:

> “Training encouraged staff to use the system.”

> = 培訓提高使用意願。

> “New hardware enabled staff to use the system remotely.”

> = 新硬件令遠端使用成為可能。

BD. ENCOURAGE VS INCENTIVIZE

72. **encourage vs incentivize**

encourage

= broad, neutral.

incentivize

= motivate specifically by offering incentives.

> encourage recycling

> = 鼓勵回收

> incentivize recycling with discounts

> = 用折扣作誘因鼓勵回收

BE. ENCOURAGE VS STIMULATE

73. **encourage vs stimulate**

stimulate

= cause increased activity/growth.

encourage

= can overlap, especially economics/biology.

> stimulate demand

> = 刺激需求

> encourage demand

> = 促進 / 刺激需求

****Stimulate**** is often more technical/economic/physiological.

BF. ENCOURAGING VS POSITIVE

74. ****encouraging vs positive****

****positive****

= favourable/good.

****encouraging****

= good specifically because it gives reason for hope/confidence.

> positive result

> = 正面結果

> encouraging result

> = 令人因而對未來更有信心的結果

Encouraging contains a future-looking implication.

BG. ENCOURAGING VS PROMISING

75. ****encouraging vs promising****

****encouraging****

= gives reason for hope.

****promising****

= appears likely to succeed or develop well.

> encouraging early results

> = 初步結果令人樂觀

> promising young researcher

> = 很有前途的年輕研究員

They overlap strongly in results/context.

BH. ENCOURAGING VS REASSURING

76. **encouraging vs reassuring**

encouraging

= increases hope/confidence about progress/future.

reassuring

= reduces fear/worry.

> encouraging progress

> = 令人對未來有信心的進展

> reassuring test result

> = 讓人安心的測試結果

BI. ENCOURAGING VS COMFORTING

77. **encouraging vs comforting**

comforting

= emotionally soothing.

encouraging

= boosts confidence/hope.

A message may be both.

BJ. ENCOURAGED VS ENCOURAGING

Classic grammar distinction.

encouraged

= person feels more hopeful/confident.

> "I felt encouraged."

= 我受到鼓舞。

encouraging

= thing causes that feeling.

> "The comments were encouraging."

= 留言令人鼓舞。

So:

> **-ed = 感受者**

> **-ing = 造成感受的事物**

BK. ENCOURAGING VS DISCOURAGING

encouraging

= gives hope/confidence.

discouraging

= reduces hope/confidence or suggests poor prospects.

> encouraging results

> = 令人樂觀的結果

> discouraging results

> = 令人失望 / 不樂觀的結果

Strong MCQ pair.

BL. DISCOURAGE VS PREVENT

discourage

= make something less likely.

prevent

= stop it from happening.

> high prices discourage purchases

> = 高價格降低購買意願

> a locked door prevents entry

> = 上鎖的門阻止進入

Important degree distinction.

BM. "ARE ENCOURAGED TO" VS "MUST"

78. **are encouraged to ≠ are required to**

are encouraged to

= 建議 / 鼓勵做；通常不是強制

must / are required to

= 必須做

Example:

> "Visitors are encouraged to book early."

= 建議早點預約。

This does not necessarily mean:

> booking is compulsory.

Excellent formal-language distinction.

BN. ENCOURAGE IN YOUR PASSAGE

Your passage says:

> “Many were kind, generous and genuinely funny... However, not all comments were ****encouraging****.”

Here ****encouraging**** specifically contrasts with comments that:

- * criticised the writer’s appearance
- * criticised the writer’s voice
- * criticised the way the writer walked
- * accused the writer of trying too hard
- * called the video “cringe”

So the exact semantic contrast is:

> ****encouraging comments****

> = comments that support, praise, reassure, or make the writer feel good/confident

versus

> ****harsh comments****

> = comments that criticize, mock, or make the writer feel exposed.

Family-extension sweep

Following the fullest-reference style, the useful modern inventory includes:

- * ****encourage someone**** = 鼓勵某人 / 給某人信心
- * ****encourage someone to do**** = 鼓勵某人做.....
- * ****encouragement**** = 鼓勵 / 支持 / 勉勵
- * ****words of encouragement**** = 鼓勵的話
- * ****encouraging — supportive**** = 令人受到鼓舞的
- * ****encouraged**** = 受到鼓舞 / 更有信心的
- * ****be encouraged by**** = 因.....而受到鼓舞
- * ****encourage something — promote**** = 鼓勵 / 促進某行為
- * ****encourage participation**** = 鼓勵參與
- * ****encourage engagement**** = 促進互動
- * ****encourage adoption**** = 推動採用
- * ****encourage growth**** = 促進增長 / 生長
- * ****encourage development**** = 促進發展

* **encourage investment** = 鼓勵投資
 * **encourage innovation** = 鼓勵創新
 * **encourage competition** = 促進競爭
 * **encourage learning** = 促進學習
 * **encourage curiosity** = 激發好奇心
 * **encourage independence** = 培養自主性
 * **encourage collaboration** = 促進協作
 * **encourage communication** = 促進溝通
 * **encourage bad behaviour** = 助長不良行為
 * **encourage violence/crime** = 助長暴力 / 犯罪
 * **encourage dependence** = 助長依賴
 * **encourage spending** = 刺激消費
 * **encourage demand** = 刺激需求
 * **encourage production** = 促進生產
 * **encourage someone in X** = 在 X 方面支持 / 鼓勵某人
 * **encouraging sign** = 好兆頭 / 令人鼓舞的跡象
 * **encouraging results** = 令人樂觀的結果
 * **encouraging progress** = 令人鼓舞的進展
 * **encouraging trend** = 正面趨勢
 * **That's encouraging** = 這很令人樂觀
 * **not encouraging** = 不太樂觀 / 不令人安心
 * **encouragingly** = 令人鼓舞地 / 可喜的是
 * **be encouraged to do** = 獲鼓勵 / 建議做.....
 * **encourage discussion** = 促進討論
 * **encourage creativity** = 激發創意
 * **encourage self-expression** = 鼓勵自我表達
 * **encourage connection** = 促進聯繫
 * **encourage X — conditions** = 創造有利條件使 X 更易發生
 * **encourage healing/recovery** = 促進癒合 / 康復
 * **discourage someone** = 令某人洩氣
 * **discourage someone from doing** = 勸阻某人做.....
 * **discourage behaviour** = 遏止 / 降低某行為
 * **discouraged** = 洩氣的
 * **discouraging** = 令人洩氣 / 不樂觀的
 * **discouragement** = 洩氣 / 挫折感 / 抑制因素

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
encourage someone	透過支持、安慰或正面說話令某人更有信心、希望或勇氣
encourage someone to do X	給予支持 / 推動，使某人更願意去做 X
encouragement	能增加信心、希望或行動意欲的支持 / 說話

encouraging — interpersonal	能令某人更有信心、希望或感到被支持的	
encouraged	因支持、進展或好跡象而感到更有信心 / 希望的	
encourage behaviour	令某種行為更有可能發生或更普遍	
encourage participation	提高人們參與某活動的意願 / 程度	
encourage engagement	促進使用者、觀眾或參與者作出互動	
encourage growth	創造有利條件，使經濟、生物等更容易增長 / 生長	
encourage investment	透過誘因 / 條件提高投資意願	
encourage innovation	創造環境 / 誘因，使新想法和新方法更容易出現	
encourage bad behaviour	使不良行為更容易發生；助長	
encourage spending	令消費意欲增加；刺激消費	
encouraging sign	顯示事情可能向好發展、令人更有希望的跡象	
encouraging results	好到足以令人對未來更有信心的結果	
not encouraging	沒有給人好轉 / 成功希望；情況不太樂觀	
be encouraged to do	被支持 / 建議去做某事，通常語氣比命令柔和	
encourage — environmental conditions	某種條件使一個自然 / 系統現象更容易發生	
discourage someone	打擊某人信心，使其灰心	
discourage someone from doing	降低某人做某事的意願；勸阻	
discourage behaviour	令某行為變得較不可能發生；抑制 / 遏止	
discouraging	令信心下降或顯示前景不佳的	
discouragement	洩氣感；或令某種行為減少的阻嚇因素	

For your original sentence

> “However, not all comments were ****encouraging****.”

The exact meaning is:

****encouraging** = 有些留言會支持、肯定、安慰作者，令作者覺得自己的影片有價值、有人理解自己；但後面出現的批評、嘲諷和「cringe」等留言就不是這種支持性的回應。******

Natural translation:

> ******「不過，並不是所有留言都是支持性的，也不是所有留言都令人受到鼓舞。」******

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > ****encourage someone**** → 鼓勵某人
- > ****encourage someone to do something**** → 鼓勵某人做某事
- > ****encouragement**** → 鼓勵 / 支持
- > ****encouraging comment**** → 令人受到鼓舞的留言
- > ****encouraged**** → 感到受到鼓舞的
- > ****encouraging results**** → 令人樂觀的結果
- > ****encourage participation**** → 鼓勵參與
- > ****encourage growth**** → 促進增長 / 生長
- > ****encourage bad behaviour**** → 助長不良行為

- > ****encourage spending**** → 刺激消費
- > ****be encouraged to**** → 獲鼓勵 / 建議做.....
- > ****discourage someone**** → 令某人洩氣
- > ****discourage someone from doing**** → 勸阻某人做.....
- > ****encouraging ≠ merely positive**** → encouraging 特別表示「正面到足以給人希望 / 信心」